SPEECH OF JCCI AT VBF MEETING WITH
PRIME MINISTER NGUYEN XUAN PHUC ON 10 DECEMBER 2020

Presented by
Sudo

I'm Sudo from JCCI.

We would like to sincerely thank the Vietnamese Government for your continued support on business activities of Japanese companies. We would also like to express our gratitude to you for allowing a number of Japanese business persons to enter Vietnam ahead of other countries even in the situation where COVID-19 is widespread worldwide. 1,700 Japanese had entered Vietnam and are able to start or continue their missions. We hope that Japanese engineers whose missions require to stay in Vietnam for a short period of time could be facilitated to enter Vietnam in the near future.

I got the chance to visit a province with Ambassador Yamada, Embassy of Japan, and we had a very meaningful meeting with the leaders of the provincial government. During that time, I was explained about their initiative which is called "10 Promises". The promises begin with “securing a 24-hour power supply” and includes “issuing investment licenses within 3 days”, “simplifying administrative procedures”, “fostering good quality workers”, “supporting to facilitate investment license changes and investment business expansion procedures”, “implementing electronic tariff procedures”, “preventing strikes and disputes”, “establishing hotlines in the People's Committee” and “resolving investors’ demands promptly”. This includes most of the challenges that Japanese companies face as we continue our business activities in Vietnam. I was very impressed with that.

I thought about the background of these promises and there was no doubt that it was the result of the provincial governments listening sincerely to the challenges of Japanese companies in the province. At the same time, a prediction crosses my mind that if similar initiatives spread throughout Vietnam, investors will invest more in Vietnam at ease.

There are differences in administrative systems and business practices between Vietnam and Japan and it is difficult to accept the difference. However, bridging these differences through the efforts of both parties seems to be an important theme for Japanese companies to continue our business activities in Vietnam and for Vietnam to attract more FDI in the future.

We would like to ask the support of the Vietnamese Government to achieve this with a broad perspective.

With the support, an excellent relationship will be built between Japanese companies who have expanded business into Vietnam and the provincial governments, which will be propagated to other Japanese companies who consider expanding business overseas. It will make a virtuous cycle and increase FDI in Vietnam.

We have been grateful to the Vietnamese Government for your various support, and we would appreciate it if you could listen to our voice this time as well.

Thank you very much.